



5 Add compost to your crockery until the plant sits at the right height and fill around it with more compost, finishing with a layer of gravel. Water in using a fine hose.



6 Place the planted cups on saucers and the other items on the tray and glue in place; just dab glue on one or two spots on the bottom of the cups to leave space for water to drain into the saucers. Fill around the crockery with moss.



7 To hang, cut three lengths of chain to the desired hanging height using wire cutters. Attach to hooks and then to the edge of the tray. Gather the chains and fix the free ends to a ring. Hang from a strong bracket. If you like, decorate the chains by attaching vintage pieces of cutlery with fine silver wire.

CARE ADVICE

WHERE TO SITE

Alpines prefer a sunny site that is not too shady and, ideally for this arrangement, one that has shelter from strong winds. During winter and freezing weather, bring your teatime planter indoors, but keep it in a cool, light place.



WATERING AND FEEDING

Alpines thrive in dry conditions in the natural world so don't overwater – just when needed from mid-spring to early autumn, with occasional watering at other times. Do not let plants sit in water for long periods of time as this could lead to rot. Alpines do not need a lot of feed so it is best to give a weak diluted liquid feed during the growing season. Do not feed when the plants are dormant.

GENERAL CARE

Trim or prune plants with small scissors or secateurs to remove spent flower stalks and dead material. Plants will eventually outgrow their teacups so plant up into larger containers or borders elsewhere in the garden.

